was certain I had the job, I visited our minister and posed a question to him: My brother has another year of college ahead of him, I said, but he is going to have to leave Eureka because he is running out of money; do you think the Lord would consider it a tithe if I sent him $10 a month instead of putting it in the collection plate? The minister, a kind and wise man, thought about the question a moment and said, “I think that would be fine with the Lord.”

The day I arrived for work in Davenport, they put me on the air. I was a disc jockey before they invented the term: As staff announcer, I played phonograph records, read commercials, and served as a vocal bridge between our local programming and network broadcasts. I was not an immediate success as a radio announcer, to put it mildly.

Nobody had bothered to give me any instructions on how to be an announcer and I quickly proved it on the air. I stumbled over my words and had a delivery as wooden as a prairie oak. I’d have hated to have to pay for some of those first commercials I read over the air. But what really got me in trouble was a commercial I *didn’t* read.

One of my assignments was to present a half-hour program of organ music from a local mortuary; the mortuary provided the organist in exchange for a discreet plug identifying it as the source of the music.

However, the nature of this quid pro quo was never explained to me, and one night I decided I didn’t like the idea of following a romantic song like “I Love You Truly” with a veiled commercial for an undertaker, so I omitted the plug.

Understandably, the mortuary was unhappy and complained. After my previous weeks of on-the-air bumbling, the station management decided that it was time for me to find another career.

Then one of those things happened that makes one wonder about God’s having a plan for all of us.